



THE 10 BEST STARTING HANDS

1 AA

2 KK

3 QQ

4 JJ

5 TT

6 AKs

7 AKo

8 AQs

9 KQs

10 AJs

Almost always raise these first in, from any seat.

s = suited (same suit) · o = offsuit · T = Ten

HAND TIERS

PREMIUM

AA, KK, QQ, JJ, AKs, AKo

Raise from any position, re-raise aggressively

STRONG

TT–88, AQ, AJs, ATs, KQs

Raise from most positions, slow down vs heavy 3-bets

SPECULATIVE

Small pairs 77–22 · suited connectors (JTs, T9s, 98s) · suited aces (A2s–A9s)

Mostly late position; need cheap flops + position

TRASH · FOLD

Weak offsuit aces (A4o) · king-rag (K3o) · low offsuit junk

Fold preflop — these cost chips every session

OPENING CHART BY POSITION (9-MAX)

POSITION	OPEN RANGE	KEY HANDS TO ADD
UTG Early	Top ~13%	TT+, AJs+, AKo, KQs
MP Middle	Top ~17%	Add 88, 99, ATs, KJs, QJs, JTs
CO Cutoff	Top ~27%	Add 55–77, A9s+, KTs+, suited connectors (T9s, 98s)
BTN Button	Top ~43%	Add 22–44, A2s+, suited broadways, weaker offsuit hands

The later you act, the wider you open. **6-max:** every seat plays ~one position wider.
% = share of all 1,326 combos. Hands shown are each seat's core; the UTG core is 58 combos (~4%) — a full ~13% range is wider.

♥ ~80% of hands you're dealt should be folded preflop.

♦ Suited adds only ~2–3 points of equity (AKs vs AKo ≈ 2) — position matters more.

♠ Most-called worst hand: **7-2 offsuit**.